

Sunday, 31 May 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

22° 17°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

20° 15°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

19° 15°

GLASGOW

Light rain

17° 13°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

Champions League final still not free to air despite pressure.

Fans will need a subscription to watch the Champions League final between Arsenal and PSG after TNT Sports decides against making the match free to air.

UK · NEWS

2

US, UK and Australia to develop underwater drone technology.

The technology, developed under the Aukus military pact, is aimed at protecting undersea cables and boosting naval defence.

UK · NEWS

3

Sturgeon wishes she had not kept Murrell on as SNP chief executive.

The former first minister says she didn't think it was fair that Murrell - who embezzled more than £400,000 from the SNP - should lose his job when she became SNP leader.

UK · NEWS

02 – SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1

Endless creepy yellow corridors, 30bn TikTok views - and now a Hollywood film.

YouTuber Kane Parsons' eerie YouTube series has been adapted for a film called Backrooms.

SHOWBIZ · UK

2

An unhealthy focus on sex - Married at First Sight UK insiders on show's 'toxic' culture.

Fresh revelations come after two women told the BBC they had been raped on the Channel 4 reality show.

SHOWBIZ · UK

3

Dame Mary Berry on her love of gardening and why she has no plans to retire.

The TV cook offers gardening tips and tells young people to "work hard and follow your dreams".

SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

1

Baseball fan gets lucky with two catches in one night.

A baseball fan couldn't believe his luck as he catches the ball twice during an MLB match between the Baltimore Orioles and the Toronto Blue Jays.

SPORT · UK

2

Stormers beat Cardiff to seal URC semi-final spot.

Stormers will either face a trip to play Leinster in Dublin or a home tie against fellow South African side Lions next weekend.

SPORT · UK

3

A team in need of change - why Liverpool parted with Slot.

Why did Liverpool call time on head coach Arne Slot after two seasons in charge in which the club won the Premier League title?

SPORT · UK

4

24 Hours with Ella Toone coming soon.

Watch the trailer for a new BBC Sport documentary offering unprecedented behind-the-scenes access to Manchester United and England star Ella Toone as she prepares for her wedding, while still coming to terms with the loss of her father.

SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Britain's most-stolen supermarket item in 2026 isn't meat or cheese — it's olive oil, with theft up 220% year on year.**
Prices have nearly doubled in two years. Some shops have fitted security tags to single bottles, others have moved premium brands behind the counter — like cigarettes.
- 2 Half of UK adults can't name a single member of the cabinet — but 80% can name three Love Island contestants.**
Political engagement researchers say it's not apathy so much as 'noise overload'. People remember faces from things they actively watch.
- 3 Brits spend an average of 38 minutes a day deciding what to watch — and 12 of those are spent scrolling Netflix.**
'Watch-paralysis' has its own subreddit. Streamers are quietly experimenting with 'shuffle' buttons that just play something.
- 4 More than half of UK workers would take a 10% pay cut to never go into the office again — but only 17% of bosses say they'd offer one.**
The gap is growing again after forced return-to-office rules. HR experts say the tension shows up in resignation rates, particularly for under-35s.
- 5 Cash is making a small comeback — ATM withdrawals are up 14% on this time last year.**
Bank analysts credit budget-conscious households using cash to stay disciplined. The 'envelope method' is back trending on TikTok.
- 6 Brits now spend an average of 14 hours a week on streaming — more than cooking, cleaning and exercising combined.**
The biggest jump is in the over-55s, who used to be the holdouts for live telly. 'Second-screening' means we pay less attention than ever.
- 7 Holiday firms report a 40% spike in 'shoulder season' bookings — September and October sun trips are way up on last year.**
Travellers blame school-holiday flight prices, unreliable summer weather, and 'August feels too crowded these days'. Spain, Greece and Portugal top the wish list.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 57% of UK workers admit doing THIS while on a work call. What?

ANSWER: GOING TO THE LOO.

Q Asked what makes them feel old, the top answer wasn't grey hairs — it was THIS. What?

ANSWER: NOT RECOGNISING ANY OF THE NAMES AT THE TOP OF THE CHARTS.

TALK TOPIC

- **Apparently 1 in 5 of us have a 'comfort show' we've watched more than 10 times.**

Talk-back: what's yours? Friends? Gavin and Stacey? Bake Off? Reveal yourself.

- **If you could un-invent ONE thing from modern life, what would it be?**

Talk-back: not phones. Pick something specific. Self-checkouts? Wireless earbuds that always die? The Selfridges Christmas advert?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT

Food. The UK's bestselling biscuit in 2025 wasn't the Custard Cream or the Hobnob — it was the humble digestive, selling over 70 million packs.

FICTION

Made up, but believable. A Bristol bakery has started selling 'controversial' jam doughnuts injected with mustard instead of jam, claiming a 'small but loyal' customer base.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A blue whale's tongue alone weighs as much as an elephant.
- Octopuses can taste with their suckers.
- Wales has more castles per square mile than any other country in the world.
- Bananas grow upside down.
- Your nose can detect over a trillion different scents.
- The unicorn is the national animal of Scotland.
- There are more trees on Earth than stars in the Milky Way.
- A snail can sleep for three years at a time.

On this day

Day 151 of the year, 214 days left in 2026. Today Anniversary of Royal Brunei Malay Regiment (Brunei); Christian feast day: Blessed Camilla Battista da Varano; Christian feast day: Cantius, Cantianus, and Cantianilla; Christian feast day: Hermias. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Emerald.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1954 — Vicki Sue Robinson, American actress and singer (died 2000)
- 1991 — Azealia Banks, American singer-songwriter and rapper
- 1946 — Debbie Moore, English model and businesswoman
- 1930 — Clint Eastwood, American actor, director, musician, and producer
- 1972 — Christian McBride, American bassist and record producer
- 1963 — Wesley Willis, American singer-songwriter and keyboard player (died 2003)
- 1938 — Peter Yarrow, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer (died 2025)
- 1934 — Jim Hutton, American actor (died 1979)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1962 — The West Indies Federation dissolves.
- 2019 — A shooting occurs inside a municipal building at Virginia Beach, Virginia, leaving 13 people dead, including the shooter, and four others injured.
- 1997 — The Confederation Bridge opens, linking Prince Edward Island with mainland New Brunswick.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1961 — The South African Constitution of 1961 becomes effective, thus creating the Republic of South Africa, which remains outside the Commonwealth of Nations until 1 June 1994, when South Africa is returned to Commonwealth membership.
- 2008 — Space Shuttle Discovery launches on STS-124 carrying the second portion of the Japanese Kibō module to the International Space Station.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1955 — The U.S. Supreme Court expands on its Brown v. Board of Education decision by ordering district courts and school districts to enforce educational desegregation "at all deliberate speed."
- 1962 — The West Indies Federation dissolves.

- 1941 — Anglo-Iraqi War: The United Kingdom completes the re-occupation of Iraq and returns 'Abd al-Ilah to power as regent for Faisal II.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 152 of the year, 213 days left in 2026. Today Children's Day (International), and its related observances: The Day of Protection of Children Rights (Armenia); Children's Day (International), and its related observances: Mothers' and Children's Day (Mongolia); Christian feast day: Blessed Alfonso Navarrete; Christian feast day: Annibale Maria di Francia. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1940 — René Auberjonois, American actor (died 2019)
- 1950 — Michael McDowell, American author and screenwriter (died 1999)
- 1963 — David Westhead, English actor and producer
- 1945 — Linda Scott, American singer
- 1937 — Rosaleen Linehan, Irish actress
- 1959 — Alan Wilder, English singer-songwriter, keyboard player, and producer
- 1944 — Robert Powell, English actor
- 1991 — Zazie Beetz, German-American actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2008 — A fire on the back lot of Universal Studios breaks out, destroying the attraction King Kong Encounter and a large archive of master tapes for music and film, the full extent of which was not revealed until 2019.
- 1988 — The Intermediate-Range Nuclear Forces Treaty comes into effect.
- 1990 — Cold War: George H. W. Bush and Mikhail Gorbachev sign a treaty to end chemical weapon production.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1979 — The first black-led government of Rhodesia (now Zimbabwe) in 90 years takes power.
- 1961 — The Canadian Bank of Commerce and Imperial Bank of Canada merge to form the Canadian Imperial Bank of Commerce, the largest bank merger in Canadian history.

Coming to cinemas

MAY 2026

FRI 15	Mortal Kombat II (+ IMAX); Is God Is; Poetic License
FRI 22	The Mandalorian and Grogu (+ IMAX)

JUNE 2026

FRI 5	Masters of the Universe; Power Ballad
FRI 12	Scary Movie 6; new Spielberg film (+ IMAX)
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026

WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

MAY 2026		JULY 2026	
THU 14	PGA Championship begins (Golf)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
WED 20	UEFA Europa League Final	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
SAT 23	EFL Championship Play-off Final, Wembley	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
SUN 24	Premier League final day (all 10 games, 3pm BST)	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
24 MAY – 7 JUN	French Open (Tennis)	23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
THU 28	Premier League Darts Finals Night	AUGUST 2026	
SAT 30	UEFA Champions League Final	W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
JUNE 2026		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
THU 4	NBA Finals begin	22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)		
11–14 JUN	World Cup of Darts		
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)		
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)		
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon		